KLOUD KART | DATA STRATEGY ENGAGEMENT

A safer foundation for trusted business reporting

Board recommendation and 12-month delivery plan

Prepared for Nana Adjei and the Board

EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

The decision in one minute

Protect the live shop first. Build trusted daily reporting second. Expand analytics only when the evidence supports it.

1 Separate reporting

Use the approved second server for a MySQL read replica. Run routine extracts away from the live website database.

2 Agree the numbers

Define revenue and order measures jointly across Finance and Operations. Automate daily reporting and reconciliation.

3 Govern and grow

Control customer-data access and exports. Hire two specialists. Defer a full warehouse and broad real-time analytics.

Board ask: approve the phased approach, the second-server reporting separation, and recruitment of two data roles—subject to the privacy, security and licensing checks in this plan.

SITUATION DIAGNOSIS

The current setup creates avoidable business risk

Live system carries two jobs

Orders, inventory and customer accounts share a MySQL database and server with website traffic. The database is about 40 GB.

Reporting is disruptive

Monday exports involve hundreds of thousands of rows. Reporting slowed the live website twice last month.

Trust and control are weak

Finance and Operations produce different figures. Marketing customer lists reach about 300,000 people, with copies not tracked.

The underlying causes

- **Shared infrastructure:** operational transactions and heavy analytical queries compete for the same resources.
- **No common reporting rules:** departments may calculate revenue and order measures differently.
- **Weak data governance:** customer copies, access, retention and deletion are not sufficiently visible.
- **Limited capacity:** one PHP/MySQL developer is supporting an environment with no dedicated data team.

RISK PRIORITIES

What happens if Kloud Kart does not act?

1	**Website performance and sales**	Critical	Heavy reporting can slow the live shop and disrupt customer transactions.
2	**Customer-data control and compliance**	Critical	Untracked copies make access, deletion and complaint handling difficult to evidence.
3	**Conflicting management figures**	High	Finance and Operations cannot confidently use one revenue view for decisions.
4	**Key-person and capability dependency**	High	Data work depends heavily on one application developer and manual effort.
5	**Premature platform investment**	Medium	A warehouse, lakehouse or real-time programme could add cost before requirements are proven.

Cost exposure should be quantified during discovery; no unsupported GHS savings or loss estimates are assumed.

Recommended architecture: isolate reporting, protect transactions

Live MySQL primary

Website orders
Live stock checks
Stock updates

MySQL read replica

Second server
Reporting reads
Replication monitored

Prepare & validate

SQL + Python
Daily refresh
Quality checks

Power BI

Daily reports
Dashboards
Authorised users

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Live stock availability and stock-changing transactions stay on the primary database. The replica and daily dashboards are not the authority for live stock decisions.

The replica is for reporting separation—not a backup or disaster-recovery replacement. Monitor replication delay and test before relying on it.

REPORTING PRINCIPLES

Match data freshness to the decision being made

Daily: management and performance reporting

Revenue • order performance • customer and operational trends
Refresh from the reporting environment once per day. Use agreed definitions and reconciliation checks.

Live: stock and order transactions

Stock availability • stock-changing transactions

Keep these decisions on the primary operational database so they use current authoritative information.

How trust is established

- **One definition:** Finance and Operations agree how revenue, refunds, discounts and cancellations are treated.
- **One controlled report:** both teams use the same approved source and reporting period.
- **Visible checks:** missing, duplicated and inconsistent records are flagged for investigation.

GOVERNANCE AND COMPLIANCE

Customer-data governance must be part of the foundation

Kloud Kart must be able to explain where customer information is held, who can access it, why it is used and how it is deleted.

Know where it is

Create an inventory of customer-data locations, exports, recipients and third-party sharing.

Control access

Limit access to authorised staff. Record exports and review permissions regularly.

Prove deletion

Document retention and deletion steps, including how copies and exports are located and addressed.

Review practices against Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), and assess requirements relevant to the planned Nigeria expansion. Treat the 90-day DPC complaint response as a case constraint—not as a general statutory deadline.

Before Power BI Service is used: assess cloud data transfer, data minimisation, user access, gateway security and licence costs.

ROADMAP: NOV 2026 – OCT 2027

A 12-month sequence ordered by risk retired

Q1

NOV 2026 – JAN 2027

Protect the live shop

Nana can run or receive Monday reporting without heavy reporting queries on the live database. Before-and-after extract and website response timings are available by 31 Jan.

Q2

FEB – APR 2027

Make the numbers agree

By 30 Apr, Nana and Finance use the same report and agree on the March revenue figure, with the revenue definition documented in plain language.

Q3

MAY – JUL 2027

Find problems before customers do

By 31 Jul, Nana can see how stock discrepancies are flagged and investigated, including the share caught before an oversell; customer-data locations and deletion steps are documented.

Q4

AUG – OCT 2027

Decide what to invest in next

By 31 Oct, Nana receives a performance and cost review. Any forecasting pilot is compared with actual demand before further investment is proposed.

Quarterly completion is judged by Nana's observable business outcome—not by whether a technology component was merely deployed.

PEOPLE AND INVESTMENT

Two hires, with infrastructure and licence costs made visible

Hire 1: Data Engineer

Own the replica, data extraction, scheduled pipelines, monitoring, technical access controls and operating documentation.

Hire 2: Analytics Engineer / Analyst

Own metric definitions with Finance and Operations, data validation, reconciliation and Power BI dashboards.

Budget categories to confirm before final allocation

- **People:** two salaries, recruitment and onboarding.
- **Infrastructure:** second server, storage, monitoring and backup arrangements.
- **Reporting:** Power BI licences, gateway and administration requirements.
- **Governance:** data mapping, access reviews, retention/deletion process and compliance assessment.

No GHS total is presented until salary, hosting and licence quotations are confirmed.

What the board is being asked to approve

Approve the direction

1. Use the second server for a MySQL read replica and move routine reporting off production.

2. Keep live stock decisions on the primary database; use daily refreshes for other reporting.

3. Adopt Power BI as the initial reporting tool, subject to security, gateway, cloud-data and licence review.

4. Recruit the two agreed roles in sequence: Data Engineer, then Analytics Engineer/Analyst.

5. Prioritise customer-data inventory, access, retention and deletion controls.

Nana's verification checklist

- Monday reporting no longer causes measurable website degradation.
- Finance and Operations use the same agreed revenue figure.
- Daily reports are available without manual CSV reconstruction.
- Stock decisions still use current operational data.
- Customer-data copies and deletion actions can be traced.
- Further platform investment is supported by cost and value evidence.

Discovery will confirm baseline performance, actual costs, causes of reporting differences, data-copy locations and Power BI deployment requirements.

PROPOSED BUSINESS IMPROVEMENT

Going beyond the brief: Tracking customer data deletion

Kloud Kart cannot easily confirm where customer information has been copied or whether it has been removed from all relevant locations when a deletion request is received.

The proposed solution

Record

Log the request and date received.

Locate

Identify systems, exports and files containing the information.

Assign

Give an employee responsibility for the request.

Resolve

Carry out the appropriate action and record evidence.

Verify

Confirm completion or document why the request remains outstanding.

WHAT NANA GAINS

- Visibility of outstanding deletion requests.
- Clear responsibility for each request.
- Evidence of actions taken.
- Better control over customer information.

TOOLS USED

- Microsoft Forms
- Microsoft Excel
- SharePoint
- Power Automate

Success measure: Every request is recorded, assigned, tracked and supported by evidence of its outcome.

Build trust before complexity.

Separate reporting from the live shop. Give Finance and Operations one agreed view. Protect customer information. Invest in advanced analytics when the foundation is ready.

Kloud Kart Data Strategy | Board discussion